018. Al-Kahf ~ The Cave

110 Ayaat (Makki)

FOCUS

NARRATIVES DRAWING ATTENTION TO DIVINE TESTS OF FAITH, WEALTH, OBEDIENCE, KNOWLEDGE AND AUTHORITY WOVEN TOGETHER WITH ACCOUNTABILITY.
INEXHAUSTABILITY OF DIVINE WORDS.

DID YOU KNOW?

THE CHAPTER FOCUSES ON BARZAKH WHICH IS THE TEMPORAL STATE BETWEEN DEATH AND UNIVERSAL JUDGEMENT. IN THE STORY OF THE YOUTHS OF THE CAVE, THEIR SLEEP REPRESENTS THE INTERMEDIATE REALM BETWEEN LIFE AND DEATH. WITH REGARD TO PROPHET MUSA AND KHIDR IT IS THE JUNCTURE OF THE TWO SEAS AND IN THE STORY OF DHULQARNAYN IS THE OPENING BETWEEN THE TWO MOUNTAIN BARRIERS WHICH HE SEALED AND WILL BE DESTROYED BEFORE THE DAY OF JUDGEMENT

SELECTED AYAAT

18:9	People of the cave
18:23	Do not say tomorrow
18:46	Wealth and children - adornment of the world
18:60	Prophet Musa (pbuh) and Prophet Khidr (pbuh)
18:83	Zhilqarnayn
18:94	Yajuj (Gog) and Majuj (Magog)
18:103	Greatest losers
18:109	Words of Allah inexhaustible

NARRATIVE

THE CHAPTER BEGINS WITH THE ASSERTION THAT THE QUR'AN IS THE STRONGEST STANDING MIRACLE THAT WIL NOT SWAY. IT CONTINUES WITH THE NARRATIVE OF THE INHABITANTS OF THE CAVE FROM WHICH THE CHAPTER TAKES ITS NAME. THEY LEFT THEIR HOMES TO ESCAPE RELIGIOUS PERSECUTION AND WERE GIVEN DIVINE PROTECTION THROUGH A MIRACULOUS SLEEP.
THIS IS FOLLOWED BY A STORY OF THE OWNERS OF TWO GARDENS WHERE ONE IS AFFLICTED BECAUSE HE IS ARROGANT AND DOES NOT EXPRESS GRATITUDE FOR BLESSINGS.
THE CHAPTER THEN MENTIONS THE DISOBEDIENCE OF SHAYTAAN WHEN IT CAME TO OBEDIENCE TO DIVINITY.
THE QUR'AN AS THAT WHICH CONTAINS EVERY KIND OF PARABLE FOR HUMAN BEINGS FOLLOWS AFTER WHICH IS MENTIONED THE NARRATION OF PROPHET MUSA AND HIS ENCOUNTER WITH PROPHET KHIDR WHO IS KEPT ALIVE BY ALLAH BEYOND THE RANGE OF NORMAL HUMAN LIFE.
THE CHAPTER THEN NARRATES THE STORY OF DHULQARNAYN WHO JOURNEYS FROM EAST TO WEST TO ESTABLISH RELIGOUS SOVEREIGNTY OVER THE LAND.
IT CLOSES WITH THE DAY OF JUDGEMENT, JANNA AND JAHANNAM AND FINALLY THE INEXHAUSTABILITY OF DIVINE WORDS FOLLOWED BY A REMINDER THAT THE PROPHET IS A HUMAN BEING TO WHOM DIVINE REVELATION WAS SENT.